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|                                                                                   | Document Title: | <b>RESEARCH PROPOSAL</b>     | Revision No.   | <b>00</b>               |
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|                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title:</b> Digital Literacy, Access to Technology, and Cultural Preservation Efforts of Ati Youth in the Municipality of Dumarao |                                                                    |
| <b>Proponent Name:</b>                                                                                                                                                 | Jezel S. Apocero                                                   |
| <b>Academic Rank:</b>                                                                                                                                                  | Assistant Professor IV                                             |
| <b>Co-Authors (with academic rank):</b>                                                                                                                                | None                                                               |
| <b>Campus/Satellite College/Address:</b>                                                                                                                               | Dumarao Satellite College                                          |
| <b>Telephone/Cell Phone/Fax Number:</b>                                                                                                                                | 09519768684/09511731559                                            |
| <b>Email Address:</b>                                                                                                                                                  | <a href="mailto:jsapocero@capsu.edu.ph">jsapocero@capsu.edu.ph</a> |

Program or Project has a component (if no, proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

|                          |  |
|--------------------------|--|
| <b>Component Title:</b>  |  |
| <b>Component Leader:</b> |  |
| <b>Academic Rank:</b>    |  |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>(2) Category (please check)</b><br><br><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields<br><input type="checkbox"/> Natural/Biological Sciences<br><input type="checkbox"/> Food Research/<br><input type="checkbox"/> Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture<br><input type="checkbox"/> Extension<br><input type="checkbox"/> Poster | <b>(3) Research Center</b><br>[Check the concerned center]<br><br><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> SSITRDC<br>Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center<br><br><input type="checkbox"/> LRDC<br>Livestock Research Development Center<br><br><input type="checkbox"/> FFRDC<br>Fisheries and Food Research Development Center<br><br><input type="checkbox"/> CSRDC<br>Crop Science Research Development Center |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                   |                |
|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>(4) Site of implementation</b> |                |
| Municipality/City:                | <b>Dumarao</b> |
| Province:                         | <b>Capiz</b>   |
| Region:                           | <b>6</b>       |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                            |                     |                                           |                                        |                                  |                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>(5) Classification</b><br><br><table> <tr> <td><b>Research:</b></td> <td><b>Development:</b></td> </tr> <tr> <td><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Basic</td> <td><input type="checkbox"/> Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td><input type="checkbox"/> Applied</td> <td><input type="checkbox"/> Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table> | <b>Research:</b>                                           | <b>Development:</b> | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Basic | <input type="checkbox"/> Pilot Testing | <input type="checkbox"/> Applied | <input type="checkbox"/> Tech. Promotion/Commercialization | <b>(6) Mode of Implementation</b><br><br><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Single Authorship/Proponent<br><input type="checkbox"/> Collaborative Research (within campus)<br><input type="checkbox"/> Collaborative Research (intercampus)<br><input type="checkbox"/> Collaborative Research (external agency) |
| <b>Research:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Development:</b>                                        |                     |                                           |                                        |                                  |                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Basic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <input type="checkbox"/> Pilot Testing                     |                     |                                           |                                        |                                  |                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Applied                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <input type="checkbox"/> Tech. Promotion/Commercialization |                     |                                           |                                        |                                  |                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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|                             |                                               |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>(7) Sector/Commodity</b> | <b>(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization</b> |
|                             | Social Science                                |

#### **(9) Rationale**

The Ati people, an indigenous group in the Philippines, have historically faced marginalization and challenges in accessing education and technology and preserving their cultural heritage. This research proposal investigates the current status of digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts among Ati Youth in Dumarao. In the Municipality of Dumarao, although modern technology has been introduced and utilized by the Ati Youth, they still encounter significant challenges related to digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation initiatives.

Despite technological advancements, many Ati Youth need more skills and access to resources to navigate the digital landscape effectively and encounter barriers to their full participation and engagement in the digital age.

Additionally, there is a risk of cultural erosion due to limited access to traditional knowledge and practices. Lack of digital literacy skills, limited access to technology resources, and threats to cultural preservation pose significant obstacles to the socioeconomic advancement of Ati Youth in Dumarao.

Addressing these challenges is crucial for promoting social inclusion, preserving indigenous culture, and fostering sustainable development in the region. It will be significant for social inclusion, cultural preservation, policy development, and community empowerment.

The research problem revolves around the intersecting challenges Ati Youth in Dumarao faced regarding digital literacy, technology access, and engagement in cultural preservation.

This study will inform policy-makers, educators, NGOs, and other stakeholders about the specific needs and challenges faced by Ati Youth in Dumarao, Capiz, and guide the development of targeted interventions to support their empowerment and cultural preservation efforts.

This study will provide the IP Youth, particularly the Ati tribe, with opportunities to be able to cope with the demands of academics in obtaining their degrees, finding decent and high-paying jobs, being highly IT-skilled persons, productive members of the community, and being advocates of Ati Cultural Heritage. Having technology skills is a rising demand in the digital age. Thus, this 'underserved and unserved' youth should also be given attention.

The output of this study, including research findings, recommendations, and best practices, will be disseminated to relevant stakeholders, including government agencies, NGOs, academic institutions, and Ati community leaders. These stakeholders can use the information to guide their programming, policy advocacy, and resource allocation efforts to support Ati Youth in Dumarao and similar indigenous communities nationwide.

Due to the lack of trainings and workshops on digital literacy and access to technological gadgets to engage in cultural preservation, this research proposal will be forwarded to fill the gaps and avoid the Ati community's digital divide and cultural erosions.

#### **(9-A) Project Description**

#### **(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem**

This study will be conducted to assess the level of digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts of Ati Youth in the Municipality of Dumarao, particularly in Barangay Aglalana and Sitio Tag-ao, Barangay Tamulalod, for the Year 2024-2025. Specifically, the study seeks to answer the following concerns:

1. What are the level of digital literacy, accessibility to technology, and cultural preservation efforts of Ati Youth toward preserving their culture?
2. Is there a significant difference between digital literacy, access to technology, and Ati Youth's cultural preservation efforts?
3. Is there a significant association between digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts of Ati Youth?
4. What are the challenges faced by Ati Youth in Dumarao in terms of digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts?

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### **(11) Review of Literature/Prior Art Search**

This study anchors many related studies examining digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts. The Ati people, an indigenous group residing in the Philippines, face unique challenges in preserving their cultural heritage while adapting to the digital age. This review synthesizes existing literature on digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts among Ati youth.

Digital literacy encompasses the skills to navigate, evaluate, and create content using digital technologies. In indigenous communities like the Ati, digital literacy is crucial in bridging gaps between traditional knowledge systems and modern technologies. Studies by Alzate et al. (2020) and Reyes (2018) emphasize the importance of incorporating culturally relevant content and pedagogies into digital literacy programs for indigenous youth. These programs empower Ati youth with digital skills and promote cultural pride and self-identity.

A Digital Literacy program spearheaded by the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT) spearheaded a workshop for a total of 35 Indigenous Peoples (IP) youth from an Aeta community, which ran from July 18 to 22 at Barangay Inararo in Porac, Pampanga. The Project was in partnership with the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples, DICT Region 3 - Free Wifi Team, Pampanga Community Service Center, and the local government unit of Porac. This activity targeted to open an opportunity to learn the "basic training course on computer and Internet essentials, computer hardware, networking, and troubleshooting, document processing, electronic spreadsheet, and multimedia presentation." (NCIP region 3, 2022)

The department also noted that its goal was to narrow the "gap of the digital divide" and allow the IP youth to become proficient with technology. "It is essential that these can also be received, understood, and used by indigenous people," DICT Pampanga added. (National News, by Luisa Cabato Jul 27, 2022).

The access to technology of the Ati Youth is a crucial determinant of digital literacy and socioeconomic development in indigenous communities. However, Ati youth often face barriers such as geographical isolation, limited infrastructure, and socioeconomic disparities. Santos (2019) research highlights the significance of community-based approaches to expanding access to technology among indigenous populations. Community-led initiatives, such as digital learning centers and mobile technology hubs, have shown promise in enhancing technology access and promoting digital inclusion among Ati youth.

Cultural preservation efforts among the Ati youth intersect with technological innovation, offering new avenues for documenting, revitalizing, and transmitting traditional knowledge. Digital tools such as multimedia platforms, mobile applications, and virtual reality simulations are increasingly used to preserve indigenous languages, oral traditions, and ecological knowledge. Studies by Cruz (2021) and Hernandez (2017) underscore the importance of co-designing digital solutions with Ati communities to ensure cultural relevance and sustainability. By integrating indigenous perspectives into technological development processes, these initiatives empower Ati youth to become active agents in safeguarding their cultural heritage.

Despite the potential benefits, several challenges exist in leveraging technology for the cultural preservation efforts of Ati youth. These include limited internet connectivity in remote areas, language barriers in digital content, and the risk of cultural appropriation in digital spaces. However, initiatives focusing on community-driven development and participatory research methodologies offer promising avenues for addressing these challenges (Dahlstrom & Siemens, 2018).

In conclusion, the literature reviewed highlights the intricate interplay between digital literacy, access to technology, and cultural preservation efforts among Ati youth. Moving forward, interdisciplinary research and collaborative partnerships between academia, government agencies, and indigenous communities are essential for designing culturally responsive interventions that address Ati youth's unique needs and aspirations in the digital age, especially in Dumarao, Capiz.

### **(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework**

This study will be anchored to the following theories, which support the concept of focus. Informed by the Capability Approach (Rehm et al., 2019), digital literacy is conceptualized as the multifaceted

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capability of Ati youth to effectively access, evaluate, and utilize digital technologies for personal, educational, and cultural purposes.

Grounded in the Digital Divide Theory (Van Dijk, 2005), access to technology refers to the availability, affordability, and usability of digital devices and internet connectivity within the Ati community. This theory highlights disparities in technology access based on socioeconomic factors and geographic location.

Social Learning Theory explores how Ati youth acquire digital literacy skills and cultural preservation efforts through social interactions, observations, and modeling within their community and through exposure to digital platforms.

Drawing from Cultural Preservation Theories (Smith, 2006), cultural preservation efforts encompass activities aimed at safeguarding and revitalizing Ati cultural heritage, including language, traditional knowledge, rituals, and practices. This framework emphasizes community engagement, intergenerational transmission, and adaptation of cultural practices to contemporary contexts.

Conceptual Framework:

#### Independent Variables

- Digital Literacy
- 
- 
- Access to Technology



#### Moderating factor

Socio-demographic profile



#### Dependent Variable

Cultural Preservation Initiatives of Ati Youth

Figure 1: This framework shows the relationships between independent and dependent variables.

### (13) Methodology

This research will utilize the Mixed-Method Research Design. Respondents of the study will be the Ati youth aged 15-24 years old (United Nations definition) residing at Sitio Tag-ao and Barangay Aglalana, both in the municipality of Dumarao, Capiz. These respondents were in their High School, College students, graduated college degree, ALS, and out-of-school youth. Simple random sampling will be utilized to draw the number of respondents for the study. Representative samples from each place will be drawn using the formula used by Cochran.

A survey questionnaire will be administered to Ati Youth in Dumarao to gather data on their digital literacy, availability and accessibility of technology, and engagement in activities/initiatives to preserve their culture. Conduct training and workshop to assess their digital literacy skills, collaborating with government agencies and other linkages. A Focus Group Discussion (FGD) will be conducted for the Ati Youth to gain insights into their challenges and opportunities related to digital literacy, access to technological gadgets and tools, and their cultural preservation efforts. Regarding ethical considerations, informed consent will be obtained from NCIP and all study participants. The participant's responses will be treated with confidentiality and anonymity. Respect for cultural sensitivity and local customs will be ensured throughout the research process.

The independent variables will be digital literacy and access to technology resources, while the dependent variables will be the cultural preservation efforts of Ati Youth.

#### Data Analysis

The data will be analyzed using SPSS. The descriptive statistics, such as frequency, means, and standard deviation, and inferential statistics, such as t-tests, correlation analysis, and Pearson r., will be analyzed and set at 0.05 alpha level. The digital literacy skills of the respondents will be assessed through a practical assessment test guided by a DICT assessor. The data from FGD will be analyzed using thematic analysis to identify patterns, themes, and insights related to digital literacy, access to technology, cultural preservation efforts, and cultural identity.

### (14) Major Activities/Work Plan

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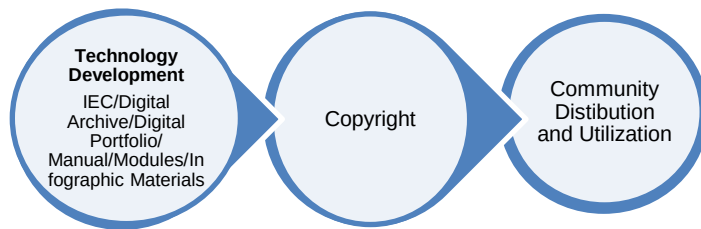
| Research Objectives                                       | Year 1: 2024 |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     | Year 2: 2025 |     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|--------------|-----|
|                                                           | Feb          | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul | Aug | Sep | Oct | Nov | Dec | Jan          | Feb |
| 1. Planning and Observation/<br>Conduct of Pre-Assessment |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |
| 2. Survey Administration and Data Collection              |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |
| 3. FGD and Qualitative Data Collection                    |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |
| 4. Data Analysis                                          |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |
| 5. Digital Literacy Skills Training                       |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |
| 6. Report Writing and Dissemination of Findings           |              |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |              |     |

#### (15) Expected Output

| EXPECTED OUTPUTS            | DETAILS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | TARGET |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| People Services             | Train selected Ati Youth for digital literacy skills and utilization of technologies.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 30     |
| Publications                | Develop/Produce a Digital Archive or Digital Portfolio and other promotional materials                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 1      |
| Patents/IP                  | File 1 copyrights for the developed IEC materials.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 1      |
| Places and Partnerships     | Forge linkages and partnerships with NCIP, DICT, DOST, LGU's, and other NGOs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 5      |
| Products                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |        |
| Policy                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |        |
| Impact on Social/ Economics | <p><i>Social Impact:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Social Inclusion and Cultural Preservation of Ati community.</li> <li>Increase in digital literacy rate among Ati Youth</li> <li>Strengthened linkages and partnerships.</li> <li>Ati Youth empowerment</li> <li>Digital equality and equity</li> <li></li> </ul> <p><i>Economic Impact:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Increase employment opportunities.</li> <li>Increase the number of Ati youth in IT-related business.</li> <li>Production of Digital literacy training modules/services</li> </ul> |        |

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#### (16) Technology Transfer Activity Design



#### (17) Target Beneficiaries

- Ati Youth
- Indigenous Community of Dumarao, Capiz
- National Commission on Indigenous People
- Department of Information and Communication Technology
- Local Government Units

#### (18) Personnel Requirement

| Name             | Role<br>(Program, Project, Study Leader) | Field of Specialization |
|------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| JEZEL S. APOCERO | Study Leader                             | Social Studies          |
| RA               | Research Assistant                       | Social Studies/ICT      |
|                  |                                          |                         |

#### Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study:

#### Program/Project Leader (in hours):

#### Program/Project Members (in hours):

#### (19) Budgetary Requirement

| SOURCES OF EXPENSES                                                                                 | Quantity               | Amount<br>(CapSU) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------|
| A. <i>Personnel Services (For studies needed the <u>Research Assistant</u>, informant/s, guide)</i> | 1 @ 11,068 x 12 months | 132,816           |
| B. <i>Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE)</i>                                           |                        |                   |
| Transportation allowance                                                                            |                        | 30,000            |
| Representation Expenses                                                                             |                        | 30,000            |
| Trainings/Workshops Expenses                                                                        |                        | 50,000            |
| Supplies (bond papers, pens, kits)                                                                  |                        | 20,000            |
| Communication Allowance (Mobile phone and internet Load)                                            |                        | 5,000             |
| Printing (modules, brochures, invitations, tarps)                                                   |                        | 10,000            |
| C. <i>Capital Outlay</i>                                                                            |                        |                   |
| Creation of a Website on the Ati Cultural Heritage                                                  |                        | 100,000           |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                        |                        | <b>357,816.00</b> |

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## (20) Literature Cited

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**Aringo and Diego (2021)** . Int. J. Bus. Manag. Soc. Res. 11(01): 577-584  
<https://doi.org/10.18801/ijbmsr.110121.61> Retrieved February 10, 2024  
[https://www.journalbinet.com/uploads/2/1/0/0/21005390/61.11.01.2021\\_impact\\_of\\_online\\_technology\\_on\\_the\\_life\\_of\\_the\\_aeta\\_native\\_in\\_the\\_northern\\_philippines.pdf](https://www.journalbinet.com/uploads/2/1/0/0/21005390/61.11.01.2021_impact_of_online_technology_on_the_life_of_the_aeta_native_in_the_northern_philippines.pdf)

**Cruz, M. (2021).** Integrating Indigenous wisdom in digital preservation: A case study of the Ati people in the Philippines. International Journal of Digital Curation, 16(1), 139-154.

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**Hernandez, E. (2017).** Indigenous peoples and digital inclusion in the Philippines: A case study of the Ati community. Journal of Global Communication, 10(2), 78-92.

**Reyes, A. P. (2018).** Bridging cultures through digital literacy: A case study of Indigenous youth in the Philippines. Journal of Indigenous Studies, 5(1), 45-60.

**Santos, R. (2019).** Community informatics and indigenous empowerment: The case of Ati youth in the Philippines. Information Development, 35(3), 455-469.

News:

DICT-Region 3-Pampanga <https://mb.com.ph/2022/7/26/aeta-youth-graduates-from-dicts-digital-literacy-program>

## (20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae

### CURRICULUM VITAE

#### APOCERO, JEZEL S.

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5811 CAPIZ, PHILIPPINES

MOBILE NO. +639519768684 EMAIL ADDRESS: [jsapocero@capsu.edu.ph](mailto:jsapocero@capsu.edu.ph)

#### PRESENT DESIGNATION

Academic Rank: Assistant Professor IV

Designations: OSA Chairperson (2017 - present)

GAD Focal Person (2017-2019)

#### EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND:

**Doctorate Degree:** Doctor of Education - Major In Social Science Education (2017-to date)  
Filamer Christian University

**Master's Degree:** Master of Arts in Teaching Major in Social Science (2014 – 2017)  
Filamer Christian University

Academic Distinction: BENE MERITUS Award: Outstanding in Research Presentation

**College: Bachelor of Secondary Education major in Social Studies (2008-2012)**

Capiz State University Dumarao Satellite College

Award: Best in Research (Paper and Poster) Regional Level